

Cansu Oner

Game Developer

Game Developer with experience developing and shipping PC and mobile games, focusing on gameplay mechanics, level design, progression, and player experience. Experienced in prototyping, playtesting, and iterating on player-focused designs through analytical problem-solving and cross-functional collaboration.

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Professional Experience

TBD Studios	Durham NC
Design Lead	Oct 2025 – Present
• Lead gameplay and level design, defining player flow, objectives, and progression across levels while making design decisions and collaborating with a 9-person multidisciplinary team. • Whitebox and iterate playable spaces, designing room layouts, traversal, and puzzle areas to create spaces that support the game's intended feel and pacing. • Prototype and implement core mechanics and custom puzzle systems in Unreal Engine 5 Blueprints, iterating on gameplay based on playtesting and team feedback.	

Duke University	Sep 2026 – Present
Serious Games Teaching Assistant	
Coordinate project progress across multiple student teams , keeping tasks and deliverables on track; contribute to one team as an Education Researcher, conducting research and participating in design meetings.	

Mediazone Games	Istanbul
Game Developer	May 2026 – Aug 2026
• Shipped 6 hypercasual mobile titles across infinite runner, puzzle, card, and trivia genres, resolving complex gameplay and UI issues including localization, WebGL compatibility, and progression systems. • Designed and developed a mobile football trivia game from scratch, implementing gameplay, UI, four distinct lifelines, progression, and game flow through live release. • Built and shipped the trivia game on Maçkolik, a leading Turkish sports platform reaching 8M+ monthly mobile users. • Took ownership of a legacy Unity codebase for the live mobile game <i>Runner Guy</i>, debugging production issues and implementing new gameplay features. • Reduced <i>Runner Guy</i> loading time from ~6s to ~1s by optimizing object pooling and gameplay initialization, while resolving localization, WebGL, UI, and progression issues.	

Christensen Center of Innovation & Avia Games	Durham NC
Game Researcher	Feb 2026 – May 2026
• Applied product management methodologies to game research, evaluating how features and design choices impacted player experience. • Analyzed data from 1,000+ player surveys to identify trends and inform client strategy. • Conducted literature reviews and academic research on player engagement for an industry-partnered project with Avia Games.	

Projects

BOT.NET - https://olatiny.itch.io/b0tnet	Game Jam
• Engaged in the full development cycle of the game from design to build. • Programmed towers and the firewalls (defense mechanisms) and the shop/ monetization system in the game.	
Tank Game	2026 Spring
• Built a 2-player arcade tank battle from scratch in Unreal Engine, featuring 2 maps, 6 game modes, 3 projectile types, and 4 gameplay power-ups. • Developed the game's local multiplayer and core gameplay framework, including keyboard/controller input, combat interactions, scoring, match flow, and custom VFX/SFX.	

Wistar Wager	Aug 2026 – Dec 2026
• Designed a level and built 2 levels with a focus on player flow and mechanical clarity.	

Education

Duke University
MEng • 4.0
Game Design, Development and Innovation
Sep 2025 – Present
Bogazici University
BSc • 3,28
Civil Engineering Jul 2025

Skills

Game Design
Level Design, Gameplay Systems, Game Mechanics, Progression
Engines
Unity, Unreal Engine 5, Godot
Programming
C++, C#, Python, GDScript, Blueprints, Problem Solving Skills
Tools
Git, Perforce, Figma, Jira, Excel, Google Sheets

Awards

People's Choice Award
Triangle Game Jam
<u>BOT.NET</u>
Best 2D Visual Identity Award
Triangle Game Jam
<u>BOT.NET</u>

Languages

English
Advanced (C1)
Turkish
Native

Certifications

Python for DSAI & Development-IBM- Coursera
Introduction to Machine Learning – Kaggle
Game Theory – Coursera